Technically, the OQ-2 was a small fixed-wing aircraft with a wingspan of approximately 12 feet (3.6 meters) and powered by a 6-horsepower engine capable of speeds up to 85 mph (137 km/h). It was controlled by a radio transmitter, allowing the ground operator to guide it through flight maneuvers such as climbs, dives, and turns closely simulating enemy aircraft movements for live-fire training exercises. The system's simplicity, durability, and ease of operation made it ideal for large-scale military use.

Between 1941 and 1945, over 15,000 Radio plane OQ-2 drones were produced, marking the first instance of UAV mass production in aviation history. These drones were used extensively across US training bases, significantly improving the accuracy and efficiency of anti-aircraft crews. The manufacturing success of the OQ-2 also established Radio plane Company (later acquired by Northrop) as a key contributor to the emerging drone industry.

The significance of the Radioplane OQ-2 lies not only in its widespread operational use but also in its role in standardizing UAV production and design principles. It proved that unmanned aircraft could be manufactured affordably, operated reliably, and deployed on a national scale for defense applications. This success encouraged continued investment in drone research, directly influencing post-war UAV development for reconnaissance and surveillance.

Figure 2.6 illustrates the *Radioplane OQ-2 (1939)*, recognized as the first mass-produced unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) developed by Reginald Denny Industries in the United States. Designed for the US Army Air Corps, this compact, fixed-wing drone served primarily as a radio-controlled target aircraft for anti-aircraft gunnery training during World War II. The image highlights its streamlined fuselage, tricycle landing gear, and small piston engine with a front-mounted propeller, reflecting its